Volume 143 / Number 2 / April–June 2023
ISSN 0003-0279

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JOURNAL OF THE AMERICAN ORIENTAL SOCIETY

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The Journal of the American Oriental Society, ISSN 0003-0279, is published quarterly in March, June, September, and December by the American Oriental Society, 913 S. University Ave., Ann Arbor, MI 48109-1190. Periodicals postage paid at Ann Arbor and additional mailing offices, USPO ID 283620. Postmaster: send address changes to Journal of the American Oriental Society, Harlan Hatcher Graduate Library, 913 S. University Ave., University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI 48109-1190.

All information about the Society and the Journal, including membership dues and the Journal style sheet, can be found at www.aos-site.org. The Society and the Editors assume no responsibility for the views expressed by authors in the Society's publications.

COMPOSITION BY LOCKWOOD PRESS, P.O. BOX 1080, COLUMBUS, GA 31901

PRINTED AT SHERIDAN PA, HANOVER, PA 17331

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Everything as One: A Linguistic View of the Egyptian Creator in the Pyramid Texts. By JOANNA POPIELSKA-GRZYBOWSKA. Travaux de l'Institut des Cultures Méditerranéennes et Orientales de l'Académie Polonaise des Sciences, vol. 5. Wiesbaden: HARRASSOWITZ VERLAG, 2020. Pp. 400. €71 (paper).

This book by Joanna Popielska-Grzybowska focuses on the intention to extract and reconstruct a view of the ancient Egyptian Creator, as described in the Pyramid Texts. The author addresses on p. 20 that the terms "creator" and "demiurge" have to be separated: a creator is a "primary and primaeval god that was . . . the stimulus, incentive, spark and thus finally the *causa prima* of the creation." The demiurge is "the Universal Fashioner." To approach this differentiation or the demiurge himself, Popielska-Grzybowska first gives an introduction to her methodological framework and valuable works on the Pyramid Texts (pp. 15–31). The second chapter is entitled "The Gods or Divine Concepts" (pp. 35–149).

In subchapters, the author presents ideas and thoughts about various gods and divine concepts that can be found in various Pyramid Texts in different pyramids. For example, the god *Rʿ*, which is mentioned as the first being (pp. 35–55), is described by his various aspects, such as his assistance in ascending to the sky, his name and recognition, his role as father, as supplier of food, his connection to the Pharaoh, his appearance and his reign, and creatures and objects that are linked to *Rʿ*.

In the third chapter (pp. 153–87), Popielska-Grzybowska treats different "Elements of Creation," such as water, earth, light, semen, sound, as well as gods such as Shu and Tefnut. The fourth chapter, "Time and Space *versus* Creation" (pp. 191–217) consists of translations and interpretations of various Pyramid texts, in which a specific period of time or a specific point in time plays a major role for creation. Another subchapter is devoted to space(s) as places of creation. There are many different spaces and places for creation, as one thinks specifically of (the) *Nwn*, but as the author correctly points out, the name of this being or space is never written as *Nwn* in the Pyramid texts, but as *Nw*, *Nwj*, *Nnw*, or *Njw*. There are also some other places connected to the act of creation in ancient Egyptian thought, as preserved in the Pyramid Texts, such as a cave or cavern *ṯpḥ.t*, or specific cities such as Heliopolis or Hermopolis.

The fifth chapter, "Means of Creation" (pp. 221–28), deals with sources for the body of a god, a goddess, or the Ennead as they were involved in the creation of the world and its parts. The sixth chapter is about "Language in Service of Creation" (pp. 231–83). Popielska-Grzybowska picks up some genres of the Pyramid Texts, which deal (at least in part) with the creation, such as injunctions, prayer-invocations, and narrations in the form of a myth, instructions, or sacred texts, which can be comprised of hymns, religious songs, litanies, and lamentations.

Another part of this chapter mentions "Verbs of Creation" (pp. 239–65). If one thinks about verbal patterns used in the Egyptian language to describe a part of creation or the creation itself, certainly words like *jrj*, *mśj*, *ḫpr*/*ḫprr*, *śḫpr*, *qm3*, *qd*, come to mind, but there are also others, such as *jwr* 'to become pregnant', *jšš* 'to expectorate', *q3j* 'to be/become high/exalted', or *tfn* 'to spit out', which play a distinct role in the Pyramid Texts for at least some portion of the creation. The last part of this chapter is a summary of the grammar used to describe the act of creation (pp. 265–81).

The seventh chapter, "Conclusion" (pp. 287–316), summarizes the different aspects, words, parts, places, etc. that have a connection to the creation in the Pyramid Texts. Popielska-Grzybowska summarises (p. 287): "The rituals, ceremonies, visual forms of veneration and institutions were made for the common people . . . while the religious texts were predestined for the use of the King and his family . . . [T]he king is the link between these two worlds, as he . . . is the embodiment and manifestation of the Creator-god," and they "believed in a time before the creation of their world in which All, or every single thing, was together in or better to say as *tm*—the all-embracing completeness." The book is completed by abbreviations (pp. 317–19), references (pp. 321–84), and indices (pp. 385–400).

Most parts of chapters II–VI are made up of transcriptions of shorter or longer Pyramid Texts or parts of these. From this reviewer's point of view, it would have been better to reproduce the Hieroglyphic text. Otherwise, the reader is forced to look into other publications that include hieroglyphics because the "normal" transcription is sometimes hard to understand. This can be exemplified on p. 221:

https://doi.org/10.7817/jaos.143.2.2023.r0031

It is not obvious that the transliteration of PT 527 §1248a and §1248b comes from two different attestations—at first glance, one might think that both are longer texts. Unfortunately, the sources are absent, and it would have been better to write exactly from which pyramid each of these texts comes from. (The first one is from the pyramid of Pepi I, the second from the grave of Pepi II.) However, a little bit later, there are no more references to two attestations: in PT 600 §1653a "your two arms" (*ꜥ.wj=k*) are referred to from the pyramid of Pepi II, but in the text of Pepi I only "your arm" (*ꜥ=k*) is mentioned, as well as in PT 600 §1653b.

Some minor remarks:

P. 20: When one reads that "Plato in his 'Timaeus' presented the demiurge as the Universal Fashioner," one misses a quote of the exact part of the Timaeus.

P. 24: The correct name is Susanne Bickel, not "Susan Bickel."

P. 41: The translation for PT 226 § 225c is missing.

P. 186: PT 511 §1161b is incorrect; it must be §1160b.

With this book, Joanna Popielska-Grzybowska presents an anthology of sources from the Pyramid Texts that deal with different aspects related to the demiurge's creation, such as locations, body parts, gods, and even the grammar used in the texts themselves. In the book, the reader gets a good compilation of the relevant texts at hand, but unfortunately parts of the volume are difficult to understand or to follow. Since, as already mentioned, no Hieroglyphs but only transcriptions are offered, it is not easy to follow the original text, so that one has to rely on the author's translations. However, if you are looking for one of the points mentioned above related to creation by the demiurge, you will find it quickly in this book.

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